

The Tow Zone Alerts mission

Tow Zone Alerts (towzonealerts.com) is an SMS alert service that helps residents manage car ownership while enjoying the benefits of city life.. This means tackling city parking and the associated penalties. The idea came when our co-founder, Eli, witnessed a line of cars (including his own) getting towed for street cleaning, and wished there was had been a warning for him and his neighbors. This founding ideas has branched into our two main projects: reminders about nearby, temporary no-parking zones (for street cleaning and street occupancy permits) and peer-to-peer alerts based on license plate reports, where neighbors can warn each other when parked in illegal spots.

By August 2025, 4,800 people have subscribed across Boston, Cambridge, Somerville, and Chelsea. From Boston's public tow logs, TZA has led to an 80% drop in towing for subscribers, preventing over 3,000 tows, 50 tons of tow truck CO2 emissions, and \$600K in towing fees. Additionally, our peer-to-peer system has facilitated over 150 "saves", where a subscriber avoids a parking penalty due to a peer alert. These early and profound successes have garnered praise and coverage from organizations such as the Boston Globe, Bay State Banner, Cambridge Day, Channel 7 News, and WBUR.

But this isn't where our story ends. As neighbors started signing up, many asked for more local information beyond parking rules – which led to the 'What's happening' text-line.



"What's Happening?"

SStime and money saved from parking hassles. 70% of subscribers opt into this experimental text line to find out about events, discounted tickets, or other worthwhile deals. We collaborate with local businesses, artists, and other organizations to source information and share it with our community.

We've featured a variety of items, including Brattle Theatre, Off the Beaten Path Food Tours, and the Biega + Kilgore Team at Compass. On average, 5% of subscribers request more information on each feature, and advertising partners consistently report new customers / event-goers due to the program. Advertising through us is simple, efficient, and effective:

1. Share your message

An advertising partner submits this form with the message they want to share, the follow up message they want interested audience members to receive, and the size / location of their preferred TZA audience.

3. Run the feature

The advertising partner sends payment through Venmo or PayPal (we ask for \$0.20 per message we send out, so getting your message to an audience of 500 subscribers costs \$100).

2. Submit your payment

The advertising partner sends payment through Venmo or PayPal (we ask for \$0.20 per message we send out, so getting your message to an audience of 500 subscribers costs \$100).

4. Track engagement

We share engagement data with you to track the effects of your message, and can work with you to track actual sales (via discount code, custom link, or something similar).



Interested in working with us? Email towzonealerts@gmail.com or call Eli Silvert at 203-903-7326 with any questions, or jump right in and submit the form on our website.